Following his victory over the Mon, Alaùngpayà devoted himself to the administrative and military reorganization of Burma. As a former village headman, Alaùngpayà realized that the problems of court administration were linked to the emergence of ministerial cliques. In order to eliminate court rivalries among patrons at court he decreed that village headmen were to be directly tied to the royal court through a combination of formal institutional obligations and personal relationships. This was designed to promote a clearer line of succession. Alaùngpayà then reconstituted the manner in which military conscription was conducted. He changed the levies from fixed quotas to variables to allow provincial governors through local jurisdictions the flexibility to fill their assigned levy by circumstance. This accommodated demographic population shifts in much of southern and central Burma accompanying the collapse of the Restored Toungoo dynasty. At the same time Alaùngpayà reorganized the military; he also changed the method of taxation from in-kind taxes to cash taxes and from agricultural to commercial revenues.

In 1758, Alaùngpayà sought to pacify the Shan principalities between the Upper Ayeyarwaddy and Yunnan. He then turned his attention to securing control of Manipur and Siam, which had always been considered crucial for security of the Ayeyarwaddy basin. While Alaùngpayà was leading an expedition against Manipur, Mon rebels seized control of Rangoon, Syriam, and Dala. Local Burmese forces were able to defeat the Mon rebels before they fled to neighboring Ayutthaya, where they were sheltered by the Siamese court. Recognizing the fact that Burma's eastern frontier wouldn't be secure as long as an Ayutthaya-Mon alliance was in place, Alaùngpayà decided to attack the source of the Mon's support and sanctuary, the kingdom of Siam.

THE WAR WITH SIAM

Alaùngpayà and two of his sons, Naungdawgi and Hsinbyushin, would wage war on Siam for over 60 years. During the dry season of 1759, Alaùngpayà launched an invasion of Siam through Mergui and Tenasserim. King Borommaracha managed to confront Alaùngpayà outside the town of Kui with an army of 15,000 but was easily defeated. Subsequently, the Burmese went on to capture the cities of Phetburi, Ratburi, and Suphanburi on the Gulf of Siam on their way to lay siege to the Siamese capital of